

The living Bible, paraphrased

A Thought for Thought Translation
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Chapter 1

1 When God began creating the heavens and the earth , 2 the earth was at first a shapeless , chaotic mass , with the Spirit of God brooding over the dark vapors.3.Then God said , " Let there be light . " And light appeared . 4.And God was pleased with it , and divided the light from the darkness . So he let it shine for awhile , and then there was darkness again . He called the light " daytime , " and the dark ness " nighttime . " Together they formed the first day.e 6 And God said , " Let the vapors separate¹ to form the sky above and the oceans below . " 7.So God made the sky , dividing the vapor above from the water below . This all happened on the second day . 9. Then God said , " Let the water be neath the sky be gathered into oceans so that the dry land will emerge . And so it was . Then God named the dry land " earth , " and the water " seas . " And God was pleased . 11.And he said , " Let the earth burst forth with every sort of grass and seed - bearing plant , and fruit trees with seeds inside the fruit , so that these seeds will produce the kinds of plants and fruits they came from . " And so it was , and God was pleased . 13 This all occurred on the third day.h 14. Then God said , " Let there be bright lights in the sky to give light to the earth and to identify the day and the night ; they shall bring about the seasons on the earth , and mark the days and years . " And so it was . 16 For God made two huge lights , the sun and moon , to shine down upon the earth - the larger one , the sun , to preside over the day and the smaller one , the moon , to preside through the night ; he also made the stars . 17 And God set them in the sky to light the earth , 18 and to preside over the day and night , and to divide the light from the darkness . And God was pleased . 19 This all happened on the fourth day.i 20 Then God said , " Let the waters teem with fish and other life , and let the skies be filled with birds of every kind . " 21. So God created great sea creatures , and every sort of fish and every kind of bird . And God looked at them with pleasure , and blessed them all . " Multiply and stock the , " he told them , and to the birds he said , " Let your numbers increase . Fill the earth ! " 23 That ended the fifth day . oceans , : 24 And God said , " Let the earth bring forth every kind of animal - cattle and reptiles and wildlife of every kind . " And so it was . 25 God made all sorts of wild animals and cattle and reptiles . And God was pleased with what he had done . 26 Then God said , " Let us make a man someone like ourselves , ' to be the master of all life upon the earth and in the skies and in the seas . 27 So God made man like his Maker . Like God did God make man ; Man and maid did he make them . 28 And God blessed them and told them , " Multiply and fill the earth and subdue it ; you are masters of the fish and birds and all the animals . 29 And look ! I have given you the seed - bearing plants throughout the earth , and all the fruit trees for your food . 30 And I've given all the grass and plants to the animals and birds for their food . " 31 Then God looked over all that he had made , and it was excel lent in every way . This ended the sixth day.

Chapter 2

1. Now at last the heavens and earth were successfully completed , with all that they contained . 2 So on the seventh day , having finished his task , God ceased from this work he had been doing and God blessed the seventh day and declared it holy , because it was the day when he ceased this work of

creation . Here is a summary of the events in the creation of the heavens and earth which the Lord God made . 5 There were no plants or grain sprouting up across the earth at first , for the Lord God hadn't sent any rain ; nor was there anyone to farm the soil . 6 (However , water welled up from the ground at certain places and flowed across the land .) 7. The time came when the Lord God formed a man's body from the dust of the ground and breathed into it the breath of life . And man became a living person . 8 Then the Lord God planted a garden in Eden , to the east , and placed in the garden the man he had formed . 9 The Lord God planted all sorts of beautiful trees there in the garden , trees producing the choicest of fruit . At the center of the garden he placed the Tree of Life , and also the Tree of Conscience , giving knowledge of Good and Bad . 10 A river from the land of Eden flowed through the garden to water it ; afterwards the river divided into four branches , 11. One of these was named the Pishon ; it winds across the entire length of the land of Havilah , where nuggets of pure gold are found , also beautiful bdellium and even lapis lazuli . 13 The second branch is called the Gihon , crossing the entire length of the land of Cush . 14 The third branch is the Tigris , which flows to the east of the city of Asher . And the fourth is the Eu phrates . 15 The Lord God placed the man in the Garden of Eden as its gardener , to tend and care for it . 16. But the Lord God gave the man this warning : " You may eat any fruit in the garden except fruit from the Tree of Conscience - for its fruit will open your eyes to make you aware of right and wrong , good and bad . If you eat its fruit , you will be doomed to die . 18 And the Lord God said , " It isn't good for man to be alone ; I will make a companion for him , a helper suited to his needs . 19. So the Lord God formed from the soil every kind of animal and bird , and brought them to the man to see what he would call them ; and whatever he called them , that was their name . But still there was no proper helper for the man . 21 Then the Lord God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep , and took one of his ribs and closed up the place from which he had removed it , 22 and made the rib into a woman , and brought her to the man . 23 " This is it ! " Adam exclaimed . " She is part of my own bone and flesh ! Her name is ' woman ' because she was taken out of a man . 24 This explains why a man leaves his father and mother and is joined to his wife in such a way that the two become one person . 25 Now although the man and his wife were both naked , neither of them was embarrassed or ashamed.